

It's with a sense of pride that you light a "10,000 wala" to mark the start of festivities, your choice of crackers are defined by their destructive potential. All this is nothing more than an indication of the appetite for destruction that we all try to feed. This very same appetite, scaled a million-fold is what most wars are all about. Our appetite for destruction is insatiable and no matter how civilised we pretend to be, it's an innate desire that's been hardcoded into our DNA.

In this cover story we aim to satiate that desire from an intellectual stand-point. We'll be adopting a blinkered perspective if you will, ignoring the horrific nature of war, the casualties, the pain and suffering. We'll be focussing on war only from a more technological stand-point, the tools of the trade, the weapons and the technology. We will marvel at the ingenuity of the human race and ignore the barbarity of war.

HOW DO WE FIGHT?

All of us know what war is, we've already defined it earlier in the article. However, how does one go about fighting a war? The various weapons and technology that we're aware of have been created for use in wars, but obviously, there is some specific thought-process that went into their creation. Why, for example, would a tank require an APFSDS round instead of a HESH round?

War is an armed conflict, but there are many types of armed conflicts ranging from civil to nuclear war, varying only in the scale of destruction.

THERE IS A KIND OF QUEASY JOY IN SEEING SOMETHING BLOWN TO SMITHEREENS BY THE CALCULATED FEROCITY AND DISTURBINGLY CREATIVE MINDS OF OUR SPECIES

Whatever the type of war being fought, the basics of warfare don't change and even Alexander the Great will have an excellent understanding of today's military tactics, once he wraps his head around 20th century equipment of course. The weapons have changed, but the tactics remain the same.



All war requires tremendous sacrifice. It's best we not forget that, ever.

There are many arguments as to how a war is fought but the general consensus is this, infantry are the focal point of any sort of military operation (we're not counting assassination missions involving precision munitions and lone targets deep behind enemy lines). The whole point of the rest of the military, be it the air-force, navy or armoured units is to support the infantry in their push to achieve their objectives. There are many who'll argue otherwise, but what we're stating here is

so on and so forth. Not to mention a whole other rock-paper-scissors thing going on in the air (fighters, bombers, recon, etc.), on land (tanks, tank destroyers APCs, LCVs, trucks, etc.) and at sea (destroyers, cruisers, aircraft carriers, submarines) and more. But it's never this simple. There are too many variables. The weapons at our disposal are now too powerful and portable to fall into a clearly defined category.

Finding the perfect balance between all these factors is what makes a great military force and the person with the ability to understand and utilise them to their full potential makes for a great general. Understanding the true scope of military might and the very nature of armed conflict is well beyond the scope of this magazine, but hopefully, the following pages will give you a better idea with regards to what you can expect in future conflicts.

With this story we aim to educate you on the basics of warfare from a technological stand-point. A sort of rudimentary guide-book to the weapons of war. This is far from a comprehensive look at all things military, but as always, the aim of the article is to pique your interest in what can be a very fascinating field of study. For more information, head over to <http://dgit.in/DigitMay2k14> 

just the general consensus of a group of respected military tacticians.

It's a complicated game of rock-paper-scissors and one might try to boil it down to this: armour destroys infantry, aircraft destroy armour, special infantry destroy armour and aircraft, the navy provides support, special armour destroys aircraft and